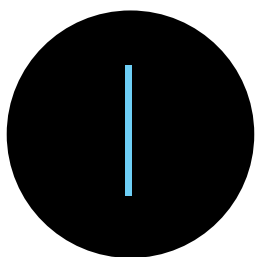


Storytelling in a New India

The time to exploit our stories is here for the film-makers. Be it our epics, folklore or history, we already have the landscape to build our own story



IN GENERAL, I do not really look into the future. To be very honest, I rarely go beyond my next film. That said let me attempt to put together a few thoughts on what India@100 could be.

From a film-making perspective, I see an ocean of opportunities. Just look at what we have in India. There is a treasure trove of stories filled with innumerable nuances. Without a doubt, no other country has this kind of wealth. It is remarkably unique to India and our culture. However, we have barely touched the tip of this huge iceberg and in that sense, I must say justice has not been done.

Let us look at the West for a moment, where storytelling is not really in their culture but what they have achieved is mind-boggling. The positive for us is that the situation has changed in the recent past. Hollywood is looking at the rest of the world, especially India. With the pandemic, people have been significantly exposed to the cultures of other countries



BY S.S. RAJAMOULI

and the size of the opportunity is hitting us. The time to exploit our stories is here for the film-makers. Unfortunately, we lack belief in ourselves but once that takes place, the world is our oyster.

I am often asked what is the role of imagination in my profession. Simply said, it is everything. Be it our epics, folklore or history. Imagine the landscape one already has to build your own story. From the time I was a boy, storytelling was an obsession and that has not changed to this day! In my way, I am living my dream and perhaps the ability to tell stories is a talent I have been blessed with. Or it has just come naturally.

The inspiration does not come through every moment that I live. Rather, it is once in a while and that difference must be understood. There is not one right way to creativity and people must look at it differently. I hold no professional qualifications in dramatics and have developed it over time. This was by reading books and being with people. There are no set rules here and an exciting thought could come from anywhere or, for that matter, anytime.

As we move into an age where technology will only gain greater importance, we must use it well. Technology is merely a tool. Take the example of a camera, which is all about technology but how you use it is where technique becomes important. Likewise, VFX is a tech-